THE UNIVERSITY OF BRITISH COLUMBIA

# 2019W1 UBC Individual TA Report for ECON 355 001 (TA) - Introduction to International Trade (Bufang Duan)

Project Title: **2019W1 UBC TA Evaluations**

Course Audience: **100**
Responses Received: **34**
Response Ratio: **34%**

**Report Comments**

## Recommended Minimum Response Rates

| Class Size | Recommended Minimum Response Rates based on 80% confidence & ± 10% margin |
|---|---|
| < 10 | 75% |
| 11 - 19 | 65% |
| 20 - 34 | 55% |
| 35 - 49 | 40% |
| 50 - 74 | 35% |
| 75 - 99 | 25% |
| 100 - 149 | 20% |
| 150 - 299 | 15% |
| 300 - 499 | 10% |
| > 500 | 5% |

Creation Date: **Friday, March 4, 2022**

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## TA Questions

| Question | N | n | SD | D | N | A | SA | N/A | IM | DI | Mean | STDEV |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| The TA was helpful when I requested course-related assistance. | 100 | 34 | 1 | 0 | 4 | 12 | 13 | 4 | 4.3 | 0.4 | 4.2 | 0.9 |
| The TA was well-prepared for their duties. | 100 | 34 | 1 | 1 | 3 | 13 | 15 | 1 | 4.4 | 0.5 | 4.2 | 1.0 |
| The TA was readily available to me either through office hours or by appointment. | 100 | 34 | 2 | 1 | 2 | 11 | 18 | 0 | 4.6 | 0.5 | 4.2 | 1.1 |
| The TA communicated at an appropriate level for me. | 100 | 34 | 1 | 0 | 6 | 9 | 14 | 4 | 4.4 | 0.5 | 4.2 | 1.0 |
| The TA exhibited interest in the subject matter. | 100 | 34 | 1 | 1 | 5 | 12 | 14 | 1 | 4.3 | 0.5 | 4.1 | 1.0 |
| The TA showed knowledge of the subject matter. | 100 | 34 | 1 | 0 | 3 | 11 | 18 | 1 | 4.6 | 0.4 | 4.4 | 0.9 |
| The TA presented information clearly. | 100 | 34 | 1 | 0 | 4 | 13 | 12 | 4 | 4.3 | 0.4 | 4.2 | 0.9 |
| The TA was effective at stimulating interest in the subject matter. | 100 | 34 | 2 | 1 | 4 | 10 | 11 | 6 | 4.2 | 0.6 | 4.0 | 1.2 |
| The TA was receptive to a variety of perspectives and ideas. | 100 | 34 | 2 | 0 | 3 | 12 | 10 | 7 | 4.2 | 0.5 | 4.0 | 1.1 |
| The TA treated me and other students with equal respect. | 100 | 34 | 2 | 1 | 3 | 9 | 16 | 3 | 4.5 | 0.6 | 4.2 | 1.2 |
| The TA's comments on my written work were helpful. | 100 | 34 | 4 | 0 | 4 | 7 | 11 | 8 | 4.2 | 0.7 | 3.8 | 1.4 |
| The TA encouraged intelligent and independent thought. | 100 | 34 | 2 | 2 | 1 | 11 | 11 | 7 | 4.3 | 0.6 | 4.0 | 1.2 |
| The TA's evaluation of my work was fair and reasonable. | 100 | 33 | 3 | 1 | 2 | 13 | 13 | 1 | 4.3 | 0.6 | 4.0 | 1.2 |
| The TA made a very positive contribution to this course. | 100 | 34 | 3 | 1 | 4 | 9 | 16 | 1 | 4.4 | 0.6 | 4.0 | 1.3 |

| Question | %Favourable |
|---|---|
| The TA was helpful when I requested course-related assistance. | 83% |
| The TA was well-prepared for their duties. | 85% |
| The TA was readily available to me either through office hours or by appointment. | 85% |
| The TA communicated at an appropriate level for me. | 77% |
| The TA exhibited interest in the subject matter. | 79% |
| The TA showed knowledge of the subject matter. | 88% |
| The TA presented information clearly. | 83% |
| The TA was effective at stimulating interest in the subject matter. | 75% |
| The TA was receptive to a variety of perspectives and ideas. | 81% |
| The TA treated me and other students with equal respect. | 81% |
| The TA's comments on my written work were helpful. | 69% |
| The TA encouraged intelligent and independent thought. | 81% |
| The TA's evaluation of my work was fair and reasonable. | 81% |
| The TA made a very positive contribution to this course. | 76% |

## How would you rate the overall contribution of the TA to the course?

| N | n | Very poor | Poor | Neutral | Good | Very Good | N/A | IM | DI | Mean | STDEV |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 100 | 34 | 1 | 3 | 5 | 8 | 17 | 0 | 4.5 | 0.6 | 4.1 | 1.1 |

| Question | %Favourable |
|---|---|
| How would you rate the overall contribution of the TA to the course? | 74% |

## Of the sessions in which the Teaching Assistant was involved, how often did you attend?

| Of the sessions in which the Teaching Assistant was involved, how often did you attend? | | |
|---|---|---|
| Options | Count | Percentage |
| None | 3 | 9% |
| Less than 25% | 5 | 15% |
| 25-50% | 4 | 12% |
| 51-75% | 8 | 24% |
| Greater than 75% | 14 | 41% |

## Which, if any, of the following did your Teaching Assistant do? (Please mark each element that is appropriate)

| Options | Count |
|---|---|
| Led discussion-tutorial groups | 6 |
| Held office hours | 32 |
| marked examination(s) | 30 |
| marked essay(s)-assignment(s) | 13 |
| gave classroom lectures | 2 |
| conducted labs | 1 |
| responded to email | 23 |
| Respondent(s) | 32 |

## Considering everything, how would you rate this course?

| N | n | Very poor | Poor | Neutral | Good | Very good | N/A | IM | DI | Mean | STDEV |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 100 | 34 | 1 | 1 | 7 | 15 | 10 | 0 | 4.0 | 0.5 | 3.9 | 1.0 |

| Question | %Favourable |
|---|---|
| Considering everything, how would you rate this course? | 74% |

## Please comment on any aspects, positive or negative, of your teaching assistant's (TA's) teaching, attitudes to students, class atmosphere, or any other matters affecting the quality of instruction that you consider worthy of note.

| Comments |
| --- |
| I cannot really say anything about William because everything he did was pretty much behind the scenes. He uploaded notes on canvas and marked exams but he was not really involved in lectures. |
| – He really wanted to help the students<br>– Good simple notes |
| William is clearly very knowledgeable about Economics. Unfortunately it seemed that he often didn't read my exam answers over thoroughly and therefore he missed marks. This was fine during the midterms because I could go through my midterm with him and make sure I was getting the marks I deserved.I'm a little worried about the marking for the final because I won't be able to go over my answers with him and see if he missed any marks. |
| He is alway willing to answers questions for students. He also wrote down notes for every lecture which are really helpful. |
| TA is really patient and helpful. He can use very simple examples to explain the questions. Also, he is responsible to students since he will come every classes and takes notes clearly. |
| nice |
| He was a positive aspect to this course. he was available during his office hours and made sure to answer questions everyone had |
| William was nice but he admitted to not reading through entire answers on exams which i found alarming especially when I came in to ask about a grade I got only to realize he hadnt read the entirety of one of my answers and that was why i had gotten a lower grade than i deserved. This made me nervous about the previous midterm which I hadnt come to talk to him about.<br>Im not sure why he didnt read longer answers maybe he wasnt given enough time but it was a bit alarming. |
| I think it would be helpful if the TA led small discussion groups to facilitate conversation and debrief lecture notes every week. |
| good |
| The teaching assistant was not talking in English, when he was having a conversation with Asian student, this excluded many students. |
| Very often, teaching assistants complement the quality of a course and add onto it, especially at a great school such as UBC. However, I cannot begin to explain how William (Bufang) did the exact opposite. He was always late for class, and spent most of the lectures on his tablet playing games, rather than taking notes, which he was supposed to. As a result, he did not properly perform his duties. In fact, part of his role was to post summaries of class lectures online through Canvas. However, he only did so once ever 3 or 4 lectures, and most times the notes were incoherent and incomplete. On a few occasions, he also requested students' notes to post them online, as he had not spent the lecture listening in, rather playing games on his tablet as mentioned prior. Finally, he grades the exams not based on the logic or rationnale of the answers and arguments presented, but by keywords. This leads to very unbalanced grading and to problems arising that require re–grading. Overall, I would say that the class would have been much better off with another teaching assistant. |
| Bufang is a really good TA. He is more clear understanding and knowledge that prof |
| n/a |
| Held very few office hours and cancelled them the week leading up to our exams. |
| He took notes for the class which were useful if I had to miss any classes due to sickness. Other than that I did not notice the TA's involvement in the course too much. |

## Please comment on any aspects, positive or negative, of the format and content of the course as they may have affected the teaching assistant's performance.

| Comments |
| --- |
| The notes he uploaded from the lectures were helpful. |
| He is really good. Hope he can keep his teaching style and personality to the following years |
| Great! |
| good |
| the course context is interesting |
| n/a |

# Explanatory Note

## Percent Favourable Rating

This is the percentage of respondents who rated the instructor a 4 or 5 (Agree or Strongly Agree).

## Interpolated Median

The data collected for Student Evaluations of Teaching (SEoT) are ordinal in nature, with a natural order (from 1 to 5). While the mean may be used as a measure of central tendency for such data, it is not an appropriate or accurate representation of SEoT data (cf. Stark & Freishtat, 2014). The usual measure of central tendency for ordinal data is the median. As a result, we have been reporting the mean and the median for the last several years. After considerable thought and data modeling, we now believe that the interpolated median is the best representation of the data, since it takes the frequency distribution into account.

Consider the following example from 2015W, the two classes have identical mean (3.8). However, the instructor in class 2 received 77% favourable (4-5) ratings, compared to 53% for the instructor in class 1. The Interpolated median values of (3.7 and 4.2), much better reflects the distribution of the scores above and below their respective median. Furthermore, the interpolated median is better correlated with percent favourable rating; such that an interpolated median of 3.5 on a Likert scale of 1 to 5, corresponds to 50% favourable rating.

**Frequency Distribution**

| Response for UMI | Class 1 | Class 2 |
|---|---|---|
| 5 = Strongly agree | 5 | 5 |
| 4 = Agree | 3 | 5 |
| 3 = Neither agree nor disagree | 6 | 0 |
| 2 = Disagree | 1 | 2 |
| 1 = Strongly disagree | 0 | 1 |
| | | |
| Mean | 3.8 | 3.8 |
| Median | 4.0 | 4.0 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Interpolated Median | 3.7 | 4.2 |
| Percent favourable rating | 53% | 77% |

## Dispersion Index

The dispersion Index is a measure of variability suitable for ordinal data (Rampichini, Grilli & Petrucci 2004). This dispersion index has values between zero and 1. A zero dispersion index indicates that all students in the section gave the same rating to the instructor. An index value of 1.0 is obtained when the class splits evenly between the two extreme values (Strongly Disagree & Strongly Agree), a very rare occurrence. In SEoT data at UBC, the index rarely exceeds 0.85, and mostly for evaluations not meeting the minimum recommended response rate.